

React Native Setup Guide on Linux Mint

Ordered steps from a clean system to running your first project

React Native works fully on Linux Mint for Android development. iOS apps require macOS, but you can work around this by using Expo Go directly on an iPhone, or a cloud build service like EAS Build.

Step 1: Install Core Requirements (Node.js & JDK)

This command installs nvm, then the latest Node.js LTS version, then Java JDK 17, and automatically adds the required environment variables to your bashrc file.

```
curl -o- https://raw.githubusercontent.com/nvm-sh/nvm/v0.39.7/install.sh | bash && \
source ~/.bashrc && \
nvm install --lts && \
sudo apt update && sudo apt install -y openjdk-17-jdk && \
echo 'export JAVA_HOME=/usr/lib/jvm/java-17-openjdk-amd64' >> ~/.bashrc && \
echo 'export PATH=$JAVA_HOME/bin:$PATH' >> ~/.bashrc && \
source ~/.bashrc && \
node -v && java -version
```

Step 2: Install Android Studio & Android SDK

Download Android Studio from the official site as a .tar.gz archive and extract it, since it isn't available through apt. After installing, open it once to complete the SDK setup through the graphical wizard.

Once that's done, add the SDK paths to your system environment:

```
echo 'export ANDROID_HOME=$HOME/Android/Sdk' >> ~/.bashrc
echo 'export PATH=$PATH:$ANDROID_HOME/emulator:$ANDROID_HOME/platform-tools' >> ~/.bashrc
source ~/.bashrc
```

Step 3: Create Your First React Native Project

React Native isn't installed as a standalone package — it's added automatically as a library inside your project when you create it. The easiest way for beginners is using Expo:

```
npx create-expo-app MyApp && cd MyApp
```

Or using the official React Native CLI directly (more control, slightly more setup):

```
npx @react-native-community/cli init MyApp && cd MyApp
```

Step 4: Run the App

To run the project via Expo:

```
npx expo start
```

Then scan the QR code with the Expo Go app on your phone (Android or iOS), or run it directly on an Android emulator through Android Studio.

Additional Tips

Tip	Why
Use a real phone instead of an emulator	Much faster performance on weaker machines
iOS requires macOS & Xcode	Not directly supported on Linux
Use Expo for beginners	Easier setup, no need for full Android Studio just to try it out
EAS Build as a cloud alternative	Build iOS/Android apps without needing a macOS machine